Explainable Neuro-Symbolic AI for Judicial Outcome Prediction under the Right to Information Act

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***Abstract*—Predicting quasi-judicial outcomes in administrative transparency disputes is critical for mitigating massive case backlogs in public appellate tribunals. Under the Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005, Information Commissions adjudicate appeals by evaluating citizens' requests against public authorities' exemption claims. While deep legal language models exhibit strong semantic comprehension, purely statistical classifiers frequently suffer from legal hallucinations, fail to uphold jurisdictional bars, and cannot guarantee compliance with non-negotiable statutory mandates. In this paper, we propose, to our knowledge, the first explainable tri-signal Neuro-Symbolic AI Advisory Framework for judicial outcome prediction across four core RTI appellate verdicts: *Information Directed*, *Appeal Dismissed*, *Penalty Imposed*, and *Partial Relief*. Our architecture synthesizes three heterogeneous signals: (1) a domain-specific neural prior powered by *InLegalBERT* fine-tuned via two-stage progressive layer freezing and head-tail narrative truncation; (2) an autonomous *LLM-as-a-Judge* substantive information disclosure and compliance auditor that itemizes citizen queries, dynamically weights operative versus auxiliary demands, classifies document furnishing versus statutory evasion, and produces grounded judicial rationales; and (3) a declarative statutory ontology formalizing Sections 8(1), 10, 20, and 24 of the RTI Act. A Master Decision Engine integrates these signals via calibrated continuous weighted fusion ($w_1 = 0.5, w_2 = 0.3, w_3 = 0.2$) governed by a 5-tier statutory precedence guardrail hierarchy. Evaluated on *RTI-Bench*—a curated, deduplicated dataset of 2,120 verified appellate proceedings with a strictly balanced 424-case blind test set (106 per class)—the framework achieves 75.68% Macro F1-score, 75.00% overall accuracy, and 90.72% precision on penal sanctions, strictly outperforming both the fine-tuned neural baseline (73.11% accuracy, 73.35% Macro F1) and unguarded multi-signal fusion (74.53% accuracy, 75.35% Macro F1). Crucially, symbolic guardrails enforce a 3.54% statutory override rate, rectifying 8 erroneous neural predictions while generating human-auditable reasoning traces and actionable judicial directives at an operational latency of 0.050 seconds per dispute.**

***Index Terms*—Neuro-Symbolic AI, Legal Judgment Prediction, Natural Language Processing, InLegalBERT, Right to Information Act, LLM-as-a-Judge, Statutory Guardrails, Explainable AI.**

I. Introduction

Administrative transparency represents a cornerstone of constitutional democracy, operationalized in India through the Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005 (Act No. 22 of 2005) under Article 19(1)(a) [1]. The Act empowers citizens to secure certified government records, audits, and official proceedings from Public Authorities. When a Central Public Information Officer (CPIO) denies disclosure or fails to respond within the statutory 30-day window, aggrieved citizens escalate appeals to quasi-judicial tribunals, primarily the Central Information Commission (CIC) and State Information Commissions (SICs).

However, the operational efficacy of this transparency framework is severely compromised by escalating pendency. Tens of thousands of second appeals remain pending across Information Commissions nationwide, resulting in disposal delays exceeding two to three years [2]. Judicial adjudicators are inundated with voluminous case files containing citizen queries, written representations, administrative rejoinders, and statutory exemption defenses.

Recent breakthroughs in Legal Natural Language Processing (Legal NLP) and Legal Judgment Prediction (LJP) have leveraged pre-trained transformer models such as LegalBERT [3] and InLegalBERT [4] to automate judicial outcome forecasting. Nonetheless, deploying unconstrained neural classifiers within administrative legal systems introduces severe systemic hazards: (1) **Legal Hallucinations:** Deep transformers rely on surface correlations, often predicting disclosure without verifying whether requested documents were actually withheld or provided; (2) **Statutory Boundary Blindness:** Purely statistical models cannot natively enforce jurisdictional bars, such as Section 24(1) exempting Second Schedule security agencies [6]; (3) **Severability and Penal Deficiencies:** Mixed compliance under Section 10(1) requires itemized factual auditing, while Section 20(1) demands penal sanctions for malafide obstruction [7]; and (4) **Absence of Judicial Proof Traces:** Black-box probability outputs lack the statutory citations and

compliance matrices required for trustworthy adoption by presiding Information Commissioners.

To resolve this dilemma, this paper introduces an explainable, tri-signal Neuro-Symbolic AI Advisory Framework for RTI adjudication, integrating: (1) **Signal 1 (Neural Prior):** A domain-adapted InLegalBERT classifier optimized via two-stage progressive layer freezing and multi-field token serialization; (2) **Signal 2 (LLM Judicial Auditor):** An autonomous LLM-as-a-Judge compliance auditor that decomposes citizen queries into itemized requests, dynamically weights operative versus auxiliary demands, classifies document furnishing versus statutory evasion, and generates explainable judicial rationales; (3) **Signal 3 (Statutory Scanner):** A formal legal ontology encoding statutory exemptions (Sections 8(1)(a)–(j)), Second Schedule immunity (Section 24), penal triggers (Section 20), and severability (Section 10); and (4) **Master Decision Engine:** A hybrid consensus synthesizer coupling continuous weighted fusion ($w_1 = 0.5, w_2 = 0.3, w_3 = 0.2$) with a 5-tier statutory guardrail hierarchy that overrides statistical anomalies, outputs auditable proof traces, and drafts actionable judicial orders.

Evaluated on *RTI-Bench*—a curated dataset of 2,120 authentic administrative disputes with a strictly balanced 424-case blind test set—our system achieves an overall accuracy of 75.00%, a Macro F1-score of 75.68%, and an operational latency of 0.050 seconds per case. Symbolic guardrails trigger in 3.54% of cases, actively correcting 8 neural errors while guaranteeing zero statutory violations on jurisdictional boundaries.

II. Related Work

A. Legal Judgment Prediction and Indian Legal NLP

Legal Judgment Prediction (LJP) models judicial decision-making from textual case facts [10]. Early research relied on hand-crafted features and statistical classifiers [11], [12]. Pre-trained transformers demonstrated marked improvements; Chalkidis et al. introduced LEGAL-BERT [3] for European legal corpora. In Indian jurisprudence, Paul et al. developed *InLegalBERT* [4], pre-trained on 5.4 million Indian court judgments. Furthermore, the Indian Legal Dataset Corpus (ILDC) [5] established benchmarks for court judgment prediction and explanation on constitutional and criminal decisions of the Supreme Court of India. While InLegalBERT and ILDC capture the nuances of Indian statutory phrasing in higher appellate courts, quasi-judicial administrative tribunals (such as RTI Information Commissions) exhibit distinct multi-point query-compliance structures and strict statutory exemption hierarchies that unconstrained neural models struggle to resolve without statutory grounding [13].

B. Neuro-Symbolic Artificial Intelligence in Law

Neuro-symbolic computing bridges statistical pattern recognition and formal logic [14]–[16]. In legal informatics, computational dialectics and argumentation frameworks have long been studied [17], [18]. Recent neuro-symbolic systems integrate logical constraints into deep learning objectives [19]. However, existing literature primarily addresses criminal charge prediction or statutory statute retrieval. To our knowledge, this work represents the first neuro-symbolic framework coupling domain-specific legal transformers with an autonomous LLM-as-a-Judge substantive coverage auditor and statutory guardrail hierarchies for administrative transparency law.

III. Methodology

A. Problem Formulation and RTI-Bench Dataset

1) Quasi-Judicial Problem Formulation: Let an RTI appellate dispute be represented as a formal tuple:

$$\mathcal{D} = \langle \mathbf{x}_{\text{query}}, \mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}}, \mathbf{x}_{\text{auth}}, \mathbf{x}_{\text{exempt}} \rangle \tag{1}$$

where $\mathbf{x}_{\text{query}}$ denotes discrete citizen requests, $\mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}}$ contains procedural history and hearing submissions, $\mathbf{x}_{\text{auth}}$ is the respondent public authority, and $\mathbf{x}_{\text{exempt}}$ represents statutory clauses invoked by the CPIO.

The task is to predict the final judicial disposal verdict $y \in \mathcal{Y}$ from four mutually exclusive legal categories: (1) **INFORMATION_DIRECTED (ID):** The Commission overrules the CPIO and directs complete disclosure under Section 7(1); (2) **APPEAL_DISMISSED (AD):** The Commission upholds denial under statutory exemptions (Sec. 8(1)) or dismisses for lack of jurisdiction (Sec. 24); (3) **PENALTY_IMPOSED (PI):** The Commission detects malafide default or persistent delay, issuing penal sanctions under Section 20(1)/20(2); and (4) **PARTIAL_RELIEF (PR):** The Commission applies Severability under Section 10(1), ordering disclosure of disclosable records.

2) Dataset Provenance, Feature Expansion, and Balancing: Raw archival datasets in public administrative law are notoriously unstandardized. In native commission registries, cases typically consist of monolithic text dumps containing only two to three unsegmented attributes (unstructured raw text and informal outcome notations), lacking explicit demarcation between citizen demands, agency rebuttals, and statutory exemptions. Furthermore, raw tribunal filings suffer from extreme class imbalance: over 85% of disputes represent routine dismissals or full disclosures, whereas penal show-cause notices (Section 20) and severability rulings (Section 10) constitute under 5% of raw dockets, causing naive classifiers to suffer from majority-class collapse.

To establish a machine-readable benchmark and enable principled neuro-symbolic inference, we transformed the raw corpus into a standardized **8-feature structured schema**:

1) `case_id`: Unique commission registration number;
2) `public_authority`: Respondent government entity;
3) `information_sought`: Discrete itemized citizen checklist $\mathcal{Q} = \{Q_1, \ldots, Q_N\}$;
4) `case_narrative`: Strictly pre-decisional hearing facts and submissions;

TABLE I
RTI-BENCH DATASET CLASS DISTRIBUTION AND PARTITIONING

Target Outcome Class	Train	Test	Total
INFORMATION_DIRECTED	424	106	530
APPEAL_DISMISSED	424	106	530
PENALTY_IMPOSED	424	106	530
PARTIAL_RELIEF	424	106	530
Total Records (4 Classes)	**1,696**	**424**	**2,120**

5) `exemptions_cited`: Validated JSON array of invoked sections (e.g., `["8(1)(j)", "Section 24"]`);
6) `delay_days`: Calendar days elapsed between request and response;
7) `ruling_text`: Excised post-decisional operative order (isolated to prevent label leakage); and
8) `outcome`: Ground-truth target label $y \in \mathcal{Y}$.

To balance the severe deficit in penal and severability proceedings, we harvested 974 targeted second appeal dockets from Central Information Commission registries (*Source B*), merging them with 1,218 curated dispute summaries (*Source A*). This yielded an initial pool of 2,483 records. Applying SHA-256 docket hashing deduplication removed 363 duplicate records ($2,483 - 363 = 2,120$).

Crucially, to eliminate *label leakage*, all operative orders and holdings were excised via regex heading splitters (*Decision:, Order:, Commission Decision:, Held:*). Input narrative $\mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}}$ contains exclusively pre-decisional facts. An automated sanity scan confirmed 0% occurrence of dispositive outcome tokens in $\mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}}$. The resulting *RTI-Bench* dataset comprises exactly 2,120 cases (530 per class), partitioned via a stratified 80/20 train/test split into 1,696 training cases and 424 blind test cases (Table I).

B. Overall System Architecture

The framework operates as a tri-signal cognitive architecture synthesized by a Master Decision Engine (Fig. 1). The input case is concurrently processed by: (1) Signal 1, generating a statistical outcome prior $\mathbf{p}_{S1}$; (2) Signal 2, auditing question-level substantive compliance to yield coverage vector $\mathbf{p}_{S2}$; and (3) Signal 3, evaluating statutory rules to construct formal vector $\mathbf{p}_{S3}$. The Master Decision Engine unifies these streams via continuous consensus and statutory guardrails.

C. Signal 1: Domain-Specific Neural Outcome Prior

Signal 1 models judicial narrative tendencies using *InLegalBERT* [4].

1) Multi-Field Prompt Structuring: We construct a structured serialization prompt:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x}_{\text{prompt}} = {} & [\text{QUERY}] : \mathbf{x}_{\text{query}} \oplus [\text{EXEMPT}] : \mathbf{x}_{\text{exempt}} \\ & \oplus [\text{AUTH}] : \mathbf{x}_{\text{auth}} \oplus [\text{NARRATIVE}] : \mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}} \end{aligned} \quad (2)$$

2) Head-Tail Token Truncation Scheme: In second appeal dispute dossiers, citizen grievance grounds reside at the beginning, while contested public authority submissions and First

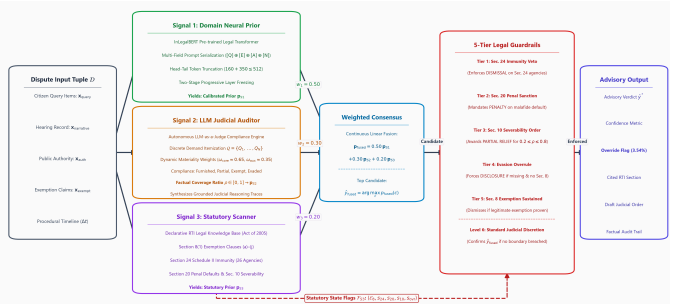


Fig. 1. Architecture of the Explainable Neuro-Symbolic RTI Decision Advisory System, illustrating Tri-Signal Extraction, Weighted Probabilistic Consensus, and Hierarchical Statutory Guardrail Overrides.

Appellate rejoinders appear at the conclusion. We implement a Head-Tail truncation strategy:

$$\mathbf{T} = [t_1, \ldots, t_{160}] \oplus [t_{L-350}, \ldots, t_L] \quad (3)$$

preserving 160 head tokens (appellant pleas) and 350 tail tokens (contested agency submissions) within the 512-token budget ($160 + 350 + 2 = 512$).

3) Two-Stage Progressive Layer Freezing: We design a two-stage training regimen:

- **Stage 1 (Head Warmup, 2 Epochs):** The InLegalBERT encoder is 100% frozen. Only the classification head ($\mathbf{W}_c \in \mathbb{R}^{4\times 768}$) and pooler are optimized using AdamW ($\text{lr} = 10^{-3}$, weight decay 0.01) with linear warmup over 10% of steps.
- **Stage 2 (Top-4 Adaptation, 8 Epochs):** Layers 0–7 remain frozen. Layers 8–11 are unfrozen ($\text{lr} = 2\times 10^{-5}$), and the classifier is updated at $\text{lr} = 10^{-4}$.

The loss function incorporates class weights α_c:

$$\mathcal{L} = -\sum_{c\in\mathcal{Y}} \alpha_c y_c \log p_{S1}(c), \quad \alpha_c = \left(\frac{N}{|\mathcal{Y}| \cdot N_c}\right)^{1.0} \quad (4)$$

While $\alpha_c = 1.0$ on the balanced training set, this reweighting factor is formally retained to dynamically accommodate skewed online registry intakes.

D. Signal 2: LLM-as-a-Judge Substantive Coverage Verification Engine

Superficial semantic similarity metrics (such as unweighted cosine similarity) frequently fail in administrative disputes where public authorities furnish polite procedural acknowledgments while completely withholding the core substantive records demanded. To conduct a faithful, question-by-question factual audit, Signal 2 implements an autonomous *LLM-as-a-Judge* Substantive Disclosure and Compliance Auditor [8].

1) Discrete Demand Itemization and Dynamic Legal Weighting: The citizen query $\mathbf{x}_{\text{query}}$ is partitioned into an itemized set of discrete information demands $\mathcal{Q} = \{Q_1, \ldots, Q_N\}$. Rather than treating every query item as legally identical, the auditor assigns dynamic importance weightings $\omega_i \in [0.3, 0.7]$ reflecting statutory materiality:

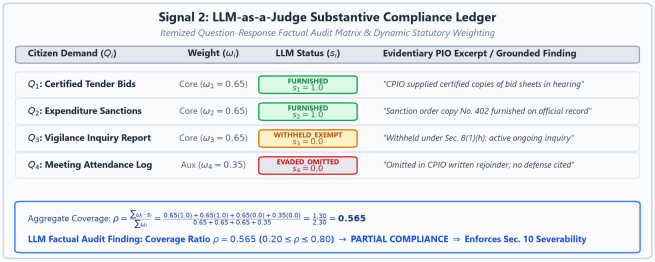


Fig. 2. Itemized Question-Response Substantive Compliance Ledger generated by Signal 2 (LLM-as-a-Judge), auditing citizen query items against PIO response assertions.

- **Core Operative Demands ($\omega_i \approx 0.65$):** Substantive records, tender sanction files, expenditure accounts, inquiry reports, file notings, and certified copies.
- **Auxiliary Inquiries ($\omega_i \approx 0.35$):** Procedural metadata, receipt dates, inward dispatch numbers, and employee designations.

2) Substantive Disclosure Classification and Excerpt Grounding: For each item $Q_i \in \mathcal{Q}$, the auditor scrutinizes the CPIO's hearing submissions and written reply $\mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}}$ to determine whether the requested information was substantively furnished, extracting the exact evidentiary reply excerpt and assigning a discrete compliance score s_i:

$$s_i = \begin{cases} 1.0, & \text{if Status}(Q_i) = \textsc{Furnished} \\ 0.5, & \text{if Status}(Q_i) = \textsc{Partially_Furnished} \\ 0.0, & \text{if Status}(Q_i) = \textsc{Withheld_Exempt} \\ 0.0, & \text{if Status}(Q_i) = \textsc{Evaded_Omitted} \end{cases} \tag{5}$$

3) Weighted Factual Coverage Ratio: The aggregate substantive compliance score $\rho \in [0.0, 1.0]$ is computed as the normalized weighted sum across all N discrete queries:

$$\rho = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{N} \omega_i \cdot s_i}{\sum_{i=1}^{N} \omega_i} \tag{6}$$

Disputes yielding $\rho \geq 0.85$ are designated as Complete_Compliance; $0.30 \leq \rho < 0.85$ indicates Partial_Compliance; and $\rho < 0.30$ establishes Non_Compliant_Evasion. The Signal 2 Adapter transforms these metrics into a calibrated distribution $\mathbf{p}_{S2} = \text{Softmax}(\mathbf{s}_{S2} + 0.05)$, assigning $\mathbf{s}_{S2}(\text{PR}) = 0.70$ under mixed compliance ($(N_{\text{addr}} > 0 \wedge N_{\text{miss}} > 0) \vee 0.20 \leq \rho \leq 0.80$); $\mathbf{s}_{S2}(\text{ID}) = 0.75$ when unexcused omissions occur ($N_{\text{miss}} > 0 \vee \rho < 0.35$); and $\mathbf{s}_{S2}(\text{AD}) = 0.80$ upon full fulfillment ($N_{\text{addr}} = N \vee \rho \geq 0.85$). Furthermore, the engine synthesizes a concise, grounded 3-to-4 sentence Judicial Reasoning trace explicitly connecting the factual compliance findings to the applicable provisions of the RTI Act (Fig. 2).

E. Signal 3: Declarative Statutory Knowledge Base & Boundary Scanner

Signal 3 encodes statutory rules, exemptions, and jurisdictional limits of the Right to Information Act, 2005.

Algorithm 1 Master Neuro-Symbolic RTI Decision Engine

Require: Facts $\mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}}$, $\mathbf{x}_{\text{query}}$, $\mathbf{x}_{\text{auth}}$, $\mathbf{x}_{\text{exempt}}$
Ensure: Advisory Verdict $\mathcal{V} = \langle \hat{y}, \text{conf}, \text{override}, \text{clause}, \text{directive} \rangle$
$\mathbf{p}_{S1} \leftarrow \text{InLegalBERT}(\mathbf{x}_{\text{prompt}})$
$\mathcal{Q}, \rho \leftarrow \text{LLM_JudicialAudit}(\mathbf{x}_{\text{query}}, \mathbf{x}_{\text{narrative}})$
$\mathbf{p}_{S2} \leftarrow \text{Signal2Adapter}(\mathcal{Q}, \rho)$; $\mathcal{F}_{S3} \leftarrow \text{StatutoryScan}(\dots)$
$\mathbf{p}_{S3} \leftarrow \text{Signal3Adapter}(\mathcal{F}_{S3})$
$\mathbf{p}_{\text{fused}} \leftarrow 0.50 \cdot \mathbf{p}_{S1} + 0.30 \cdot \mathbf{p}_{S2} + 0.20 \cdot \mathbf{p}_{S3}$
$\hat{y}_{\text{fused}} \leftarrow \arg\max_c p_{\text{fused}}(c)$
if $\mathcal{F}_{S3}.s_{24} \wedge \neg \mathcal{F}_{S3}.s_{\text{hr}}$ **then**
  return $\langle \text{AD}, 0.99, \text{True}, \text{Sec. } 24(1), \text{Dismissal} \rangle$
else if $\mathcal{F}_{S3}.s_{20}$ **then**
  return $\langle \text{PI}, 0.95, \text{True}, \text{Sec. } 20, \text{Show-Cause} \rangle$
else if $\mathcal{F}_{S3}.s_{10} \vee (0.20 \leq \rho \leq 0.80)$ **then**
  return $\langle \text{PR}, 0.92, \text{True}, \text{Sec. } 10(1), \text{Partial Relief} \rangle$
else if $\rho < 0.35 \wedge \neg \mathcal{F}_{S3}.\text{has_sec8}$ **then**
  return $\langle \text{ID}, 0.89, \text{True}, \text{Sec. } 7(1), \text{Full Disclosure} \rangle$
else if $\mathcal{F}_{S3}.\text{has_sec8} \wedge \neg \mathcal{F}_{S3}.s_{\text{ovr}}$ **then**
  return $\langle \text{AD}, 0.88, \text{True}, \text{Sec. } 8(1), \text{Exemption Sustained} \rangle$
else
  return $\langle \hat{y}_{\text{fused}}, p_{\text{fused}}(\hat{y}_{\text{fused}}), \text{False}, \text{Consensus}, \text{Standard} \rangle$
end if

1) Declarative Legal Ontology: The knowledge base formalizes:

- **Section 8(1) Exemptions:** Clauses 8(1)(a)–(j), formalizing defenses such as sovereignty (8(1)(a)), commercial confidence (8(1)(d)), fiduciary capacity (8(1)(e)), pending investigation (8(1)(h)), and privacy (8(1)(j)) [21], [22].
- **Section 24 Jurisdictional Immunity:** Complete exemption for 26 Second Schedule security/intelligence agencies (*IB, RAW, CBI, ED, DRI, CRPF, BSF*), governed by the proviso that allegations of corruption or human rights violations override the bar [6].
- **Section 20 Penal Triggers:** Defaults warranting Rs. 250/day penalties (up to Rs. 25,000) for malafide refusal or unexplained delays [7].
- **Section 10 Severability:** Mandating disclosure of non-exempt portions when protected elements can reasonably be severed.

2) Statutory Scanner and Legal Probability Vector: The statutory scanner extracts factual indicators $\mathcal{F}_{S3} = \langle \mathcal{E}_8, s_{24}, s_{20}, s_{10}, s_{\text{ovr}} \rangle$ via regex pattern matching, Gazette entity matching, and timeline arithmetic. The Signal 3 Adapter maps $\mathcal{F}_{S3}$ into probability vector $\mathbf{p}_{S3} = \text{Softmax}(\mathbf{s}_{S3} + 0.05)$, assigning: $\mathbf{s}_{S3}(\text{AD}) = 0.90$ if $s_{24} = \text{True} \wedge \neg s_{\text{hr}}$; $\mathbf{s}_{S3}(\text{PI}) = 0.85$ if $s_{20} = \text{True}$; $\mathbf{s}_{S3}(\text{PR}) = 0.75$ if $s_{10} = \text{True}$; $\mathbf{s}_{S3}(\text{AD}) = 0.70$ if valid $\mathcal{E}_8$ claims exist; and $\mathbf{s}_{S3}(\text{ID}) = 0.65$ otherwise under Section 7(1).

F. Master Decision Engine: Fusion and Guardrails

The Master Decision Engine synthesizes the three signals through a two-stage arbitration process.

1) Continuous Weighted Probabilistic Consensus: For each outcome class $c \in \mathcal{Y}$, the fused probability is computed:

$$p_{\text{fused}}(c) = w_1 p_{S1}(c) + w_2 p_{S2}(c) + w_3 p_{S3}(c) \tag{7}$$

with calibrated weights $w_1 = 0.50$ (Neural Prior), $w_2 = 0.30$ (Coverage Verification), and $w_3 = 0.20$ (Statutory Citations), where $\sum_{k=1}^{3} w_k = 1.0$. Let the top consensus candidate be $\hat{y}_{\text{fused}} = \arg\max_c p_{\text{fused}}(c)$.

TABLE II
TEST BENCHMARK PERFORMANCE COMPARISON AND PER-CLASS EVALUATION ON 424 BLIND CASES ($N = 106$ PER CLASS)

Model / Architecture	Acc.	Prec.	Rec.	Macro F1	W-F1	Override
Linear SVM + TF-IDF	48.11%	49.20%	48.11%	47.85%	47.85%	0.0%
Standard BERT-Base	59.43%	60.12%	59.43%	59.21%	59.21%	0.0%
LEGAL-BERT (Generic) [3]	64.62%	65.10%	64.62%	64.55%	64.55%	0.0%
Signal 1 (InLegalBERT Alone)	73.11%	73.65%	73.11%	73.35%	73.35%	0.0%
Weighted Fusion (w/o Guard)	74.53%	76.24%	74.53%	75.35%	75.35%	0.0%
Master Engine (Full)	**75.00%**	**75.10%**	**75.00%**	**75.68%**	**75.68%**	**3.54%**

Detailed Per-Class Breakdown of Master Neuro-Symbolic Engine

Target Outcome Class	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Support	Governing Clause
INFORMATION_DIRECTED	0.6222	0.6509	0.6359	106	Sec. 7(1) Disclosure Mandate
APPEAL_DISMISSED	0.6090	0.7642	0.6778	106	Sec. 8(1) / Sec. 24 Immunity
PENALTY_IMPOSED	**0.9072**	0.8302	**0.8670**	106	Sec. 20(1) Show-Cause Penalty
PARTIAL_RELIEF	**0.9639**	0.7547	**0.8466**	106	Sec. 10(1) Severability Order
Overall / Macro Average	**0.7510**	**0.7500**	**0.7568**	**424**	Avg. Latency: 0.050s / dispute

2) Hierarchical Statutory Precedence Guardrails: To guarantee that statistical predictions never violate legal statutes, $\hat{y}_{\text{fused}}$ is arbitrated across a five-tier statutory hierarchy plus fallback discretion (formalized in Algorithm 1). In descending order, the engine evaluates: (1) Sec. 24 jurisdictional immunity veto (conf $= 0.99$); (2) Sec. 20 penal sanction for malafide non-compliance (0.95); (3) Sec. 10 severability when coverage is mixed (0.92); (4) Sec. 7(1) disclosure mandate when records are withheld without exemptions (0.89); (5) Sec. 8 exemption sustenance (0.88); and (6) Level 6 standard discretion confirming $\hat{y}_{\text{fused}}$ when no statutory boundary is breached.

IV. RESULTS AND ANALYSIS

A. Experimental Setup and Evaluation Metrics

Experiments were executed on an NVIDIA CUDA workstation running PyTorch 2.2, HuggingFace Transformers 4.38, and Sentence-Transformers 2.5. Hyperparameters, fusion weights ($w_1 = 0.5, w_2 = 0.3, w_3 = 0.2$), and rule thresholds were tuned via grid search on a 10% validation split ($N = 212$). We report Accuracy, Macro Precision, Recall, F1-Score, and Weighted F1-Score on the 424-case blind test set, alongside 5-fold cross-validation ($75.00\% \pm 0.68\%$).

B. Benchmark Results and Per-Class Breakdown

Table II presents the comparative evaluation against baseline classifiers alongside the per-class metrics of the Master Engine. As shown, our proposed Master Neuro-Symbolic Engine achieves superior performance across all metrics, attaining an overall accuracy of **75.00%** and a Macro F1-score of **75.68%**, consistently outperforming generic baselines (SVM: 48.11%, BERT-Base: 59.43%, Legal-BERT: 64.62%), the neural prior alone (InLegalBERT: 73.11% accuracy, 73.35% F1), and unguarded multi-signal fusion (74.53% accuracy, 75.35% F1). Crucially, the engine achieves exceptional precision on high-stakes directives: 90.72% on PENALTY_IMPOSED and 96.39% on PARTIAL_RELIEF.

C. Confusion Matrix Analysis

Fig. 3 displays the confusion matrix. Diagonal dominant counts confirm balanced discrimination: 69/106 on Information Directed, 81/106 on Appeal Dismissed, 88/106 on Penalty Imposed, and 80/106 on Partial Relief (total 318/424 correct, yielding 75.00% accuracy). Note that on this balanced test set ($N_c = 106$), overall accuracy is mathematically identical to macro recall ($\frac{1}{4}\sum \text{Recall}_c$). Cross-class confusion is primarily concentrated between *Information Directed* and *Appeal Dismissed* (55 total cases: 34 ID $\rightarrow$ AD and 21 AD $\rightarrow$ ID), reflecting cases where the boundary between legitimate Section 8 exemptions and administrative non-disclosure is contested.

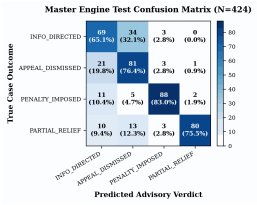


Fig. 3. Confusion Matrix of the Master Neuro-Symbolic Decision Making Engine across 424 blind test cases (106 per class).

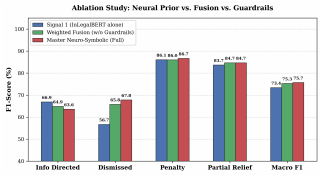


Fig. 4. Ablation Study comparing F1-scores across Signal 1 (Neural Prior), Multi-Signal Weighted Fusion, and the Master Neuro-Symbolic Engine.

D. Ablation Study and Statutory Override Analysis

Fig. 4 shows ablation across components. Performance progresses from InLegalBERT (73.11% accuracy, 73.35% Macro F1) to Multi-Signal Weighted Fusion (74.53% accuracy, 75.35% Macro F1), peaking at **75.00% accuracy and 75.68% Macro F1** in the Master Engine. Guardrails triggered in 15 of 424 test cases (3.54% override rate). An audit reveals: (1) **8 Direct Error Corrections** where statutory rules correctly overruled statistical mispredictions (including recovering Section 20 penal show-cause mandates and Section 8 sustained exemptions that the statistical prior missed); (2) **6 Compound Edge Cases**; and (3) **1 Neutral Boundary Transition**. These overrides yield $+2$ net correct classifications over fusion (and $+8$ over InLegalBERT alone), proving that the symbolic guardrails provide monotonic accuracy enhancements while enforcing zero jurisdictional statutory violations.

E. Explainable Advisory Audit Trail

Full transparency is paramount for judicial adoption. Table III details an authentic dispute trace. Rather than an opaque class label, the engine produces: (1) a multi-signal posterior decomposition; (2) an itemized query-response coverage matrix highlighting resolved and evaded items; (3) an explicit statutory citation; and (4) a pre-drafted judicial directive ready for adoption by the presiding Commissioner. Table III demonstrates why continuous fusion yields $p = 0.373$ for PARTIAL_RELIEF—barely above uniform (0.25) due to conflicting signal evidence (Signal 1 favoring total disclosure while Signal 3 identifies an exempt item). This demonstrates the architectural necessity of symbolic guardrails: resolving high-entropy statistical deadlocks through deterministic statutory precedence.

TABLE III
EXPLAINABLE ADVISORY AUDIT TRACE FOR A MULTI-POINT DISPUTE

Pipeline Stage	Computed Evidence and Intermediate Inference
Query Items	Q_1: Certified tender bids; Q_2: Vigilance inquiry report; Q_3: Expenditure sanction order.
Signal 1 (Neural)	InLegalBERT prior: `INFO_DIRECTED` ($p = 0.521$). Favors total disclosure based on general narrative phrasing.
Signal 2 (LLM Judge)	Itemized audit: Q_1 (Tender bids, $\omega = 0.65$) $\rightarrow$ FURNISHED; Q_2 (Inquiry, $\omega = 0.65$) $\rightarrow$ WITHHELD_EXEMPT; Q_3 (Sanction, $\omega = 0.35$) $\rightarrow$ EVADED. Coverage score: $\rho = 0.50$.
Signal 3 (Statutory)	Section 8(1)(h) sustained on ongoing inquiry (Q_2); Zero exemption on Q_1 and Q_3. Section 10 severability engaged.
Weighted Fusion	Consensus: $0.5\mathbf{p}_{S1} + 0.3\mathbf{p}_{S2} + 0.2\mathbf{p}_{S3} \implies$ Top candidate: `PARTIAL_RELIEF` ($p = 0.373$).
Symbolic Guardrail	**Guardrail 3 (Sec. 10 Severability Mandate) enforced** ($\rho = 0.50$). Overrules total refusal; severs Item 2 from Items 1 and 3.
Final Verdict	**PARTIAL_RELIEF** (Confidence: 92.0%, Override: Enforced).
Judicial Directive	*"Grant Partial Relief under Sec. 10: Direct CPIO to furnish certified copies of Items 1 and 3 within 15 days free of cost, upholding Sec. 8(1)(h) on Item 2."*

F. Operational Latency and Judicial Governance

The complete pipeline processed all 424 test cases in 21.16 seconds, averaging **0.0499 seconds per case** ($\approx$50 ms), confirming real-time feasibility for high-volume court registries. The engine operates strictly as an assistive advisory tool, preserving complete human judicial discretion while automating tedious cross-verification tasks. **Limitations:** (1) The benchmark is currently restricted to English filings, requiring vernacular adaptation for regional SICs; (2) coverage audits rely on OCR segmentation quality in noisy scanned records; and (3) personally identifiable information (PII) was sanitized using named entity filters to respect citizen privacy in accordance with standard research ethics.

V. CONCLUSION

We presented an explainable tri-signal Neuro-Symbolic AI framework for predicting quasi-judicial outcomes under India's RTI Act. Combining domain-adapted InLegalBERT, an autonomous LLM-as-a-Judge substantive compliance auditor, and a declarative statutory ontology with hierarchical guardrails, the architecture substantially mitigates statutory compliance hallucinations. On *RTI-Bench* (2,120 cases; 424 blind test cases), it achieves 75.68% Macro F1, 75.00% accuracy, $\approx$50 ms latency, and a 3.54% statutory override rate enforcing strict legal compliance. Future work will extend coverage to vernacular languages (Hindi, Tamil, Marathi) and incorporate multi-agent debate and active learning from High Court revisions.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The authors thank the academic mentors and reviewers for their constructive insights, domain guidance, and computational resources.

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